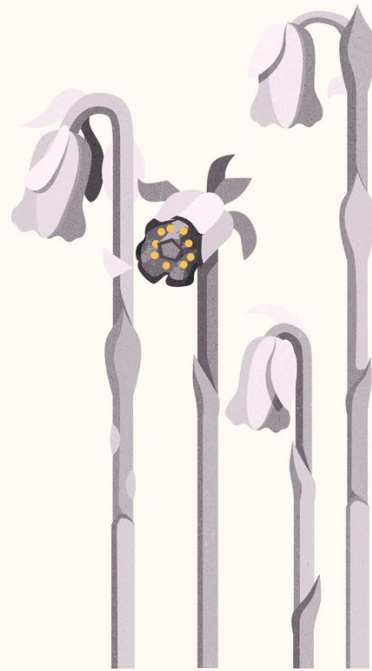


*Don't be tempted
to pick a ghost plant
flower. If you do,
it turns black.*



Ghost plant

Under the shade of the forest trees, among fallen leaves, is where you will find this pale plant. It is white as paper and waxy as a candle. You can almost see straight through it! Each little stem grows up to 30 cm (12 in) high and has a single, spooky flower.

Most plants capture energy from the Sun and turn it into sugar for food. This is called photosynthesis (photo-sin-theh-sis), and the parts of the plant that do it are what make them green. However, the ghost plant doesn't need sunlight. So how does it get its food? It sucks up nutrients from fungi living in the earth.